IQMEETEQ WORKSHOP COMPANION

Your Workbook

PARTICIPANT	TEST Claude Check
COHORT	Tier 4 CEA Leadership — Day 5 (v2)
GENERATED	October 13, 2026

CONTENTS

Table of Contents

AI CHANGE LEADERSHIP

Three Ways to Put AI to Work
Consider the Work
Anatomy of Working Software
Build Your Mini-PRD
The Tools You Have
AI, ML, and LLMs
Many Ways In
Draft with Instructions and Role
The RICECO Framework
Context
Create Your Context
Power Follow-Ups
Real Work
Where It Earns Its Place
Human in the Loop
Pattern Matching and Hallucination
What AI Is / Is Not
LLM Peer Review
Cognitive Erosion
Cognitive Growth
What Else Is Possible
Data Safety
Red / Yellow / Green
Shadow AI
The Change Message Framework
Create Your Change Message
Two Sentences
Talk It Out

REFERENCE

Three Ways to Put AI to Work

CHAT

You ask, it answers. Copilot and other chatbots. For drafting, summarizing, thinking out loud.

AUTOMATE

You set the steps, it runs them. n8n, Power Automate. For work that happens the same way every time.

DELEGATE

You give it a goal, it finds the path. A task, software, or a whole workflow — Replit, Lovable, Copilot Studio. For work where the steps are not known in advance.

Shown as examples. Not approved for Caltrans use.

> On the left, you do the work. On the right, it does the work.

What does my division do by hand that it shouldn't?

YOUR NOTES

No notes recorded

EXERCISE

Consider the Work

GOAL

Something your division could use.

You are not going to build software today. You will be speaking it into existence. Describe it well enough that what comes back is what you meant. Same skill you use with IT, with a vendor, and with the person two doors down.

1. **Look at your organization**
   Your work, your department's work, cross-department work, etc.
2. **Name what is done by hand**
   What is the process? Where does it stall? What automation or connection would make it better?
3. **Pick something to improve**
   A dashboard, connectivity between two data sets, a way to distribute information, etc.
4. **Write it in 3 or fewer sentences**
   What it should do that would solve (part of) the problem.

YOUR IDEA

What should it do that would solve (part of) the problem?

3 sentences or fewer.

No entry

SUBMITTED

YOUR IDEA: TEST — ignore

Then, at your table

1. **Share yours**
   3 or fewer sentences each. Forty seconds. No selling it.
2. **Find the one**
   Which would help the most people, or remove the most tedious step? Debate briefly.

3 **Pick it**

One per table. Share with the room during the debrief.

YOUR NOTES

No notes recorded

REFERENCE

Anatomy of Working Software

You're opening a restaurant. How do people get in?

THE DOOR

Login. Who gets in, and what each role can see.

THE DINING ROOM

Front end. What people see and touch.

THE KITCHEN

Logic. Where the rules run.

THE FREEZER

Database. Where everything is stored.

Describe those four and you have written a Product Requirements Document.

YOUR NOTES

No notes recorded

EXERCISE

Build Your Mini-PRD

GOAL

One build per table.

1. **Pick a scribe**
   Someone to type into the Workshop Companion for the group.
2. **Document your requirements**
   Fill in the boxes below, then Copy and Submit. Anthony builds from what you submit.

TABLE NUMBER

Required.

No entry

TABLE NAME

Optional.

No entry

THE GOAL

In three sentences or fewer: what should it do that nobody has to do by hand anymore?

No entry

LOGIN

Who gets in, and what each role can see.

No entry

FRONT END

What people see and touch.

No entry

LOGIC

Where the rules run.

No entry

DATABASE

Where everything is stored.

No entry

REQUIREMENTS AND CONSIDERATIONS

Anything the build has to respect.

No entry

SUBMITTED

The Goal: TEST — ignore
Login: TEST — ignore
Front end: TEST — ignore
Logic: TEST — ignore
Database: TEST — ignore
Requirements and considerations: TEST — ignore

Your builds

Links to the working prototypes will be added here during lunch.

YOUR NOTES

No notes recorded

REFERENCE

The Tools You Have

At work.

MICROSOFT COPILOT

General purpose. Drafting, summarizing, reorganizing, planning. Works across Outlook, Teams, Word, and SharePoint inside the Caltrans tenant. Best at language tasks on your own material. Weak at facts it was not given, numbers, anything it has to look up.

TRAFFIC MOBILITY INSIGHT

Purpose-built. Answers questions against a defined mobility dataset. Narrow, and accurate inside its lane. Best at the questions it was built for. Weak at anything outside the data it was pointed at.

ROAD SAFETY INSIGHT

Purpose-built. Same architecture, different data: crash and safety records. Best at pattern questions on safety data. Weak at general drafting. It is not a writing tool.

At home: Claude, ChatGPT, Gemini.

YOUR NOTES

No notes recorded

REFERENCE

AI, ML, and LLMs

Artificial Intelligence is the broad field. Machine Learning is a subset of AI — it is already in your life: fraud detection at Visa, Face ID, Netflix recommendations, Outlook spam filtering, Google Maps routing. Large Language Models are a subset of Machine Learning — Claude, ChatGPT, Gemini — and they power tools like Copilot, NotebookLM, Notion AI, Canva AI, and Gamma.

LARGE

A vast knowledge base, trained on an enormous amount of text.

LANGUAGE

Natural, like you're typing or speaking to a person.

MODEL

The name of the tool itself: Claude, GPT, Gemini, and the rest.

> The goal isn't to know everything. It's to know enough to lead, experiment, and decide.

YOUR NOTES

No notes recorded

REFERENCE

Many Ways In

How are you using LLMs today? Every one of these is a language task. None requires the tool to know a fact it was not given.

DRAFT

Memos, emails, talking points. The blank page problem.

SYNTHESIZE

Five reports into one view. Twenty comments into three themes.

DISTILL

Forty pages into one. What survives is what matters.

BRAINSTORM

Options and angles you had not considered.

PLAN

A sequence. An agenda. The questions before a vendor call.

YOUR NOTES

No notes recorded

EXERCISE

Draft with Instructions and Role

GOAL

See what each part of a prompt changes.

Run these three in order, in a new Copilot chat each time. Notice what changes.

PROMPT

```
Write an email about a new policy requiring staff to complete training within 30 days.
```

PROMPT

```
You are a supportive supervisor who knows your team is stretched thin. Write an email about a new policy requiring staff to complete training within 30 days.
```

PROMPT

```
You are a construction foreman who runs a tight ship. Write an email about a new policy requiring staff to complete training within 30 days.
```

DEBRIEF

How did the role change it?

No entry

YOUR NOTES

No notes recorded

REFERENCE

The RICECO Framework

GOAL

Six ingredients for prompts that produce usable output the first time.

The RICECO Framework

LETTER	ELEMENT	QUESTION
R	Role	Who is the AI acting as?
I	Instruction	What exactly do you want it to do?
C	Context	What background information is needed?
E	Examples	What does good look like?
C	Constraints	What rules must it follow?
O	Output Format	How should the final result be formatted?

The 80% Shortcut

You don't need all six every time. For most daily tasks, I + C + C — Instruction, Context, Constraints — gets you 80% of the way there.

YOUR NOTES

No notes recorded

REFERENCE

Context

ONE CHAT

Everything typed so far. That is what it works from. A fouled chat stays fouled — the bad assumption is in the context.

WHAT IT CAN REACH

Files, mail, documents. Some tools read what you point them at. Whether yours does is a configuration question, not a capability one.

ACROSS SESSIONS

What it remembers. Claude and GPT carry memory and projects. Copilot chat, as you have it, starts fresh each time.

TO AN AGENT

What you hand it, plus what it fetches. The leap that makes agents useful and risky at once.

Bad context is why more prompting stops helping. Know which layer the problem is in.

DRIFT

The topic wandered. Twenty exchanges in, the chat is somewhere else. Start a new one.

FOULED

A bad assumption got baked in. Every answer now leans into it. Edit the earlier prompt, or abandon the chat.

BAD REPLIES

Same wrong thing, again. More prompting will not fix it. The context is the problem. Sunset it.

YOUR NOTES

No notes recorded

EXERCISE

Create Your Context

GOAL

What do you want it to remember about you?

1. **Pick a task where the tool would need to know you**
   Where a generic answer wouldn't work, because of your audience, your division, or how it has to sound.
2. **Fill in the boxes that would have the most impact**
   Role, acronyms, formatting. Skip the rest.
3. **Copy, paste into a new Copilot chat, then type the task**
   How did your context document influence it?

ROLE

What should AI know about your role?

Your title or function and where you sit in the organization.

No entry

WORK

What should AI know about the work you're responsible for?

Recurring responsibilities that affect the help you need.

No entry

TERMS

What terminology or acronyms should AI understand without explanation?

Only terms you use regularly.

No entry

RULES

What standing rules or constraints should AI always account for?

Requirements that apply across most of your work.

No entry

TONE

What should AI know about your preferred tone?

How responses should generally sound.

No entry

FORMAT

How do you prefer information to be organized?

BLUF, bullets, sections, tables, or narrative.

No entry

DEPTH

How much detail do you usually want?

Your normal level of depth or concision.

No entry

DELIVERABLES

What kinds of deliverables do you commonly want AI to produce?

Emails, memos, briefings, talking points, or analyses.

No entry

AVOID

What should AI avoid doing?

Recurring response habits that make the output less useful.

No entry

YOUR NOTES

No notes recorded

REFERENCE

Power Follow-Ups

SIMPLIFY

"ELI12" (Explain like I'm 12)

FLIP

"Make the case against this."

FORMAT

"Turn this into a table."

SOURCE

"Where did that come from?"

CUT

"What would you remove?"

KEY PRINCIPLE

The first response is raw material, not a final product. Every follow-up is an editing decision.

YOUR NOTES

No notes recorded

EXERCISE

Real Work

GOAL

Leave with one finished.

Your real queue. Not the important things — the recurring, language-heavy things. "A briefing memo due Thursday." "Forty public comments to summarize." The one you name is the one you work on. Real material. Real deadline.

DRAFT

Create something new — email, report, talking points, agenda

Ex: Memos, emails, talking points. The blank page problem.

No entry

SYNTHESIZE

Combine many things into one view

Ex: Five reports into one view. Twenty comments into three themes.

No entry

DISTILL

Shrink something long down to what matters

Ex: Forty pages into one. What survives is what matters.

No entry

BRAINSTORM

Generate options and angles

Ex: Options and angles you had not considered.

No entry

PLAN

Sequence the work

Ex: A rollout sequence. An agenda. The questions before a vendor call.

No entry

YOUR NOTES

No notes recorded

REFERENCE

Where It Earns Its Place

Which of your real tasks suit the tools you actually have? Recurring, language-heavy work. Not anything the number has to be right on.

An agent is different. You hand it a goal. It decides what files to create, writes them, hits errors, reads the errors, fixes them, and keeps going until something ran. Their words went in. An agent did the rest.

YOUR NOTES

No notes recorded

REFERENCE

Human in the Loop

The fix isn't better AI. It's a human in the loop. Beginning: you direct. Middle: AI processes. End: you edit and oversee it.

The trap

These systems perform trust. They don't earn it. The better they get at the performance, the harder it is to remember. Your job: understand it. Don't trust it.

YOUR NOTES

No notes recorded

REFERENCE

Pattern Matching and Hallucination

An LLM predicts the next word based on massive training data. It's not retrieving a fixed answer; it's generating a likely sequence. When it lands on truth, we call it an answer. When it lands on false, we call it a hallucination. Same process either way. It doesn't know it's right. It doesn't know it's wrong. It's always guessing.

More context means better predictions. "Mary ___" could be anything. "Mary had a little ___" is almost certainly one word. Vague prompts get vague outputs. Your context is the lever.

You: That statistic you cited — where did it come from? AI: It's from the 2023 National Workforce Study by the Bureau of Labor Statistics. You: I can't find that study. Does it exist? AI: I filled in a pattern that I thought belonged there.

YOUR NOTES

No notes recorded

REFERENCE

What AI Is / Is Not

CORE CONCEPT

Pattern matching, not thinking. The same process produces correct answers and hallucinations.

IT IS

- **Probabilistic**
  Always guessing what comes next. Whether output is true or fabricated, the process is identical.
- **Pattern Matching at Scale**
  It finds connections humans might miss.
- **A Confident Communicator**
  It sounds authoritative, even when wrong.

IT IS NOT

- **Thinking or Knowing**
  There is no reasoning. There is prediction.
- **Sentient or Caring**
  It does not have feelings or intent.
- **A Reliable Fact Database**
  It is a reasoning engine, not a search engine.

YOUR NOTES

No notes recorded

EXERCISE

LLM Peer Review

GOAL

Two sets of eyes are better than one.

1. **Draft**
   One tool writes it.
2. **Critique**
   A different chat reads it.
3. **Revise**
   Back to the first chat.

PROMPT

```
Draft a [what you need].

[Paste or describe your material.]
```

PROMPT

```
You are a skeptical reviewer. Below is a draft. What is wrong, unsupported, or
missing? Critique only. Do not rewrite it.

[PASTE THE DRAFT FROM CHAT A]
```

PROMPT

```
Here's what Chat B said. Is this critique useful? Tell me which points you accept
and which you reject, and why. Then revise the draft.

[PASTE CHAT B'S CRITIQUE]
```

Different models catch different errors and carry different biases. Using them to check each other is a structural safeguard, not just a best practice.

YOUR NOTES

No notes recorded

REFERENCE

Cognitive Erosion

One possible pattern in how people use AI. The label is who wrote the first draft.

1. **Here's a draft. Critique it.**
   I did the thinking and made the first attempt. AI helps me find weaknesses.
2. **Here's a draft. Rewrite it.**
   I supply the draft and the reasoning. AI reshapes it. I judge what to accept.
3. **Draft it. I'll adjust.**
   AI makes the first attempt. I check it against my purpose and the evidence, then make the decision myself.
4. **Draft it. I'll skim it.**
   Confidence in past results starts to replace real scrutiny.
5. **Draft it. I'll send it as is.**
   I pass the answer along without checking its reasoning.

> The risk is not that AI wrote the first draft. It's repeatedly giving up the work of questioning, checking and explaining.

Ask yourself: What thinking disappeared? Can you still explain and defend what you sent?

What it looks like from your chair

WHAT FEELS DIFFERENT?

"This doesn't sound like them." "This could describe any organization." "It keeps repeating the same point." "Where did that detail come from?"

PATTERNS YOU MAY RECOGNIZE

Repeated "not X, but Y" phrasing. Everything packaged into tidy threes. Inflated vocabulary: "delve," "tapestry," "pivotal." Chatbot leftovers: "Certainly! Here's..."

Enough to ask

These are conversation cues, not proof. Ask: "How did you use AI on this?"

YOUR NOTES

No notes recorded

EXERCISE

Cognitive Growth

GOAL

What will you reinforce?

Five ways to ask AI to deepen your understanding while you do real work. Add the subject and any approved context in the chat.

PROMPT

```
Explain it using something I know.

Subject: [what you are trying to understand]
Something I know well: [an area you already understand]
```

PROMPT

```
Connect it to what I've learned.

Subject: [what you are trying to understand]
What I've learned so far: [paste the ideas or material]
```

PROMPT

```
Show me another way to look at this.

[Paste or describe the work]
```

PROMPT

```
Here's my reasoning. Challenge it.

[Your reasoning]
```

PROMPT

```
Show me how this applies to my work.

My task: [describe it]
Constraints: [what it has to work within]
```

> Use an approved tool with material permitted in that tool. Important facts still need an authoritative source or a knowledgeable person.

What leaders reinforce

ASK FOR THE REASONING

"Walk me through how you reached that recommendation."

MAKE LEARNING VISIBLE

"What do you understand better after working through this?"

REWARD THE CATCH

"Good catch. What helped you spot that?"

MODEL IT YOURSELF

"Here's how I used AI to challenge my own thinking."

NEXT WEEK

Which of these will your team see you do next week?

Pick one behavior and name the situation where you will use it.

No entry

YOUR NOTES

No notes recorded

REFERENCE

What Else Is Possible

Beyond Copilot, Traffic Mobility Insight, and Road Safety Insight. Remember the three ways: Chat, Automate, Delegate.

Automate — the path is fixed, AI can live inside it

1. **Trigger**
   Something happens.
2. **AI step**
   Summarize, classify, extract.
3. **Action**
   Update, route, create.
4. **Output**
   Notify, store, send.

The workflow does not decide what happens next. You already did.

Delegate — the path is discovered while the work is happening. Example: "Prepare Monday's executive brief." The agent pulls the calendar, project data, email updates, and policy news, asks what's missing, searches an alternate source, synthesizes, drafts. The path changes when the evidence changes.

> Some of the people you lead have used these tools. They know the gap.

YOUR NOTES

No notes recorded

REFERENCE

Data Safety

Before we talk about AI safety, let's talk about data safety. Optimize entirely for efficiency and everything is wide open. Optimize entirely for safety and we'd never send an email. Every organization lives somewhere in the middle.

"Is this safe?" is not a question that has an answer. Safe compared to what? For which material? Against which alternative you already use?

Where does your sensitive data live right now?

DOCUMENTS

BCPs, contracts, draft correspondence. SharePoint? A shared drive? A laptop?

EMAIL

Who else can read it, including the vendor?

PEOPLE

Payroll and personnel files. State system, or a vendor?

How your tools handle your data

OUTLOOK & SHAREPOINT

Stored on Microsoft's servers. Encrypted. Not used to build products for others. Kept until you delete it.

PAYROLL / HR

Stored on the vendor's servers. Encrypted. Not used to build products for others. Kept 4+ years by federal law.

COPILOT, CALTRANS TENANT

Stored in Microsoft's government cloud. Encrypted. Not used to build products for others, by contract. Kept per the state agreement.

CONSUMER AI

Stored on the AI company's servers. Encrypted. Used to build products for others only if model improvement is on. Kept until you delete it.

The security question is not "is AI safe?" It's "what's the data, what are the settings, and what does my organization allow?"

For a staffer, safety is a toggle. For you, safety is a policy: which tools your people may use, and how you find out when they use something else.

YOUR NOTES

No notes recorded

EXERCISE

Red / Yellow / Green

GOAL

Define data safety — for yourself.

GREEN · RELATIVELY SAFE

Normal business data in an approved system.

YELLOW · IT DEPENDS

Sensitive or contextual. Needs safeguards.

RED · RISKY

Should not be shared casually in any system.

Say it out loud. Twice per scenario: model improvement ON, then OFF. No answer key. The point is hearing the room disagree.

SCENARIO 1

You paste a draft public-facing press release into an LLM to make it clearer.

No entry

SCENARIO 2

You paste a contractor's name, contact details, and specific contract terms into an LLM to help draft a follow-up email.

No entry

SCENARIO 3

You paste an email thread with the Legislature's staff about a pending bill into an LLM to help draft a response.

No entry

SCENARIO 4

You paste public comments from a project hearing, naming specific residents and parcels, into an LLM to find patterns.

No entry

SCENARIO 5

You attach meeting notes that include a personnel discussion to pull out action items.

No entry

SCENARIO 6

You attach a district's quarterly delivery summary (projects, status, dollar figures) to draft an update for the Director.

No entry

WHAT CHANGES THE CALL

What would move a Yellow to Green for you?

No entry

The governance question is not "is AI safe?" It's "what's the data, what are the settings, and what does my organization allow?"

YOUR NOTES

No notes recorded

REFERENCE

Shadow AI

> Shadow AI is evidence. It tells leaders where capability, policy, and user need are out of alignment.

You did not choose it. Copilot arrived in an update — every M365 tenant got it. Gemini arrived in a browser patch that IT approved as a security fix. Connectors arrive through your own tools: an approved tool with an admin panel connects to anything. The question is not whether you have shadow AI. It is whether you can see it.

Read the signal — the workaround is telling you something

CAPABILITY

The approved tool cannot do the job. People reach outside when the sanctioned option stops short.

POLICY

The rules do not match the work. A blanket restriction collides with a legitimate operational need.

ENABLEMENT

People do not know the sanctioned path. The capability may exist; they just don't know how to reach it.

Before you punish the workaround, diagnose the gap.

"WHO IS USING UNAPPROVED AI?"

Finds a person.

"WHAT ARE THEY TRYING TO ACCOMPLISH THAT THEY CANNOT ACCOMPLISH ANOTHER WAY?"

Finds the gap.

"When the Governor's 2023 AI executive order came out, the energy went into governing AI — policies, procedures, guardrails. Almost none went into educating people on responsible use. That was a miss." — Assistant chief, state department. Public panel, state technology conference, August 2026.

SURVEILLANCE

Catch it. Stop it. People learn what not to tell you. The behavior gets harder to see, not less common.

SUNLIGHT

See it. Understand it. Ask what the tool is doing for them. Visibility gives you something you can actually govern.

Make the sanctioned path win. People choose the approved path when it gives them more, not merely when policy tells them to: approved data, shared prompts, internal knowledge, better integrations, reusable workflows. Compliance is not the incentive. Capability is.

> **Trust but verify**
>
> Enable, train, make the path known — that sets the direction and gets people to tell you what they use. Then check at machine speed. AI runs at machine speed, so the check on it has to.

Questions, ideas, or tool requests: AI@dot.ca.gov

HONEST GUESS

What is your division already using that you cannot see?

Not what they may use. What they use. Personal ChatGPT. Claude on a phone.

No entry

WHY

What need is that tool meeting that the sanctioned path does not?

No entry

MONDAY

Sunlight or surveillance? Say which, and name the first move.

No entry

YOUR NOTES

No notes recorded

REFERENCE

The Change Message Framework

You already wrote it. Now say it in order.

1. **Forces**
   What changed outside.
2. **Practices**
   How we do it today.
3. **Consequences**
   What that costs now.
4. **A stronger path**
   What we saw.
5. **Impact**
   What is different in 90 days.

Five sentences. Repeated in the all-hands, the hallway, and the one-on-one until it sticks.

SKIP THE COST

"Here is a better way." Lands as a preference. Preferences lose to the status quo.

NAME THE COST FIRST

"Here is what today costs. Here is the better way." Lands as a recovery. The same words, in that order, move people.

The brain registers a gain only against a loss. Steps 2–3 are the loss. Steps 4–5 are the gain. Skip either half and the message stops working.

YOUR NOTES

No notes recorded

EXERCISE

Create Your Change Message

GOAL

One sentence each. Eight minutes.

FORCES

The external pressure

No entry

CURRENT PRACTICES

How we do it today

No entry

CONSEQUENCES

What that costs now

No entry

A STRONGER PATH

What we saw

No entry

IMPACT

What is different in 90 days

No entry

SUBMITTED

FORCES: TEST — ignore
CURRENT PRACTICES: TEST — ignore
CONSEQUENCES: TEST — ignore
A STRONGER PATH: TEST — ignore
IMPACT: TEST — ignore

Hand it to the person next to you. They read your five sentences out loud, in order. Which sentence is weakest? Which one would your division argue with?

YOUR NOTES

No notes recorded

EXERCISE

Two Sentences

GOAL

The ones you would actually say.

Rewrite your Forces and Current Practices sentences as speech. Who hears it: a direct report who did not ask. Competent, busy, quietly skeptical. Then say it to your partner. They answer one question only: "What did you just hear me asking you to do?" If the answer is "nothing yet," the opening worked.

SENTENCE ONE

What changed outside your division.

No entry

SENTENCE TWO

How your division does that work today — said so they nod, not flinch.

No entry

YOUR NOTES

No notes recorded

EXERCISE

Talk It Out

WHAT CLICKED

One insight, technique, or moment that stuck.

An insight, technique, risk, or reward that stuck.

No entry

WHO NEEDS TO HEAR IT

A peer CEA who was not in this room. What would you tell them first?

A peer CEA, your boss, someone else who was not in this room. What would you tell them first?

No entry

Tell us how we did — two minutes in the Feedback tab, now, while it is fresh. Tomorrow: Day 6 — Leading for Lasting Impact. Same room.

YOUR NOTES

No notes recorded